

WILL MCGOWAN

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EDUCATION

University of Strathclyde, Glasgow

Sep 2023 – Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1, including 90% in first-year Finance
- Second-highest mark (78%) in a group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets
- **Relevant Modules:** Applied Econometrics, Treasury Management and Derivatives, Industrial Economics

Dissertation | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

"Who Hedges the Barrel? Sovereign Oil Hedging and Petro-Currency Reactions to OPEC News"

- Testing whether a petro-currency's oil beta shrinks, kinks or turns one-sided when its government hedges oil: Norway's krone conversions (vs unhedged Canada), Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge
- Building an original dataset from Norges Bank and the Russian and Mexican finance ministries, and testing it with event studies and difference-in-differences around each rule change
- Testing whether what remains is tradable after costs, judged by Sharpe ratio and a White reality check

Empirical CAPM Test

MATLAB

- Tested whether the CAPM explains returns on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries: it failed for 31% of portfolios individually and jointly in 48 of 53 countries, with momentum and value the most persistent

Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine

MATLAB

- Built a vectorised Monte Carlo engine pricing European and Asian options under risk-neutral GBM, benchmarked against Black-Scholes and the closed-form geometric-Asian price
- Cut the arithmetic-Asian standard error by 97% at 100,000 paths with a geometric-Asian control variate

Corn-Soybean Cointegration | group project

R

- Found corn and soybean prices cointegrated (quarterly, 1990–2022; Engle-Granger and Johansen tests); in the error-correction model both prices adjust back to equilibrium (soybean coefficient -0.29 , $p < 0.001$)

Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Le Set, Glasgow | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 – Present

- Designed the 11-drink menu for a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, including 4 original cocktails
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 pre-batched cocktails and trained around 15 staff to serve them consistently

KONG, Glasgow | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 – Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Trained new staff on drink specifications, POS and licensing rules; reconciled cash and card takings each shift

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Strathclyde Agricapital Society | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 – Present

- Co-founded the university's first agri-finance society, grew it to 126 members and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC
- Built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from futures curve structure and CFTC managed-money positioning; weekly backtest (Apr 2025 – Oct 2026): Sharpe 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, maximum drawdown 3.1%

Strathclyde Poker Society | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for around 60 players on £600 a semester, reconciling every buy-in and prize pool

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: R, MATLAB, Excel, Git

Interests: Chess, 14th at the Irish U19 Chess Championships (2023) and won 21 of 22 games in a simultaneous exhibition against players averaging 1860 FIDE; Powerlifting, Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)